

Not all full tosses are created equal: What makes Bumrah's different

Most full tosses go the distance. Jasprit Bumrah's don't. Here's why his are an **outlier** — in both numbers and narrative.

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Over the years, we have grown accustomed to seeing Jasprit Bumrah top various elite bowling charts.

However, in the just-concluded Indian Premier League (IPL) season, Bumrah finds himself at the top of a list few would have expected him to feature in.

The Mumbai Indians pacer bowled more full tosses (58) than anyone else in IPL 2025, by some distance. In fact, this is the highest number of full tosses he has delivered in a single IPL season.

Bumrah's seemingly generous offerings, though, weren't capitalised on by many. His economy of 7.44 from full tosses was the best among bowlers who sent down more than 10 such deliveries in IPL 2025. To add to that, the 31-year-old claimed six wickets with full

tosses — again, the most this season.

The inability to put away Bumrah's full tosses could be attributed to two factors: the largely quantifiable elements of swing and swerve, and the immeasurable impact of his aura.

Bumrah thrived following the return of the saliva rule, using reverse swing to great effect and making even full tosses a formidable prospect. Add to that the much-discussed snap of his wrists, which imparts heavy backspin on the ball, and it becomes harder for batters to judge, not just the length, but also the height of the delivery.

Psychologically, his hard-earned reputation plays a significant role. With most teams employing a 'do-not-take-on-Bumrah' strategy, batters often approached him with a defensive mindset, which helped the pacer even when he erred in length.

Full, fuller, fullest

Assuming full tosses are not an intentional strategy, Bumrah's glut of unbounded deliveries seems to be an outcome of trying to bowl fuller and nail more yorkers.

In IPL 2025, he sent down 32

Jasprit Bumrah ended IPL 2025 with an economy of 6.87 — the best for any bowler who delivered at least five overs in the season.